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U.S. Department of Energy
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DOE Announces $1.9B Investment to Update Critical Grid Infrastructure and Reduce Electricity Costs

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Accelerating Affordable, Reliable, and Secure Energy Through Reconductoring and Other Advanced Transmission Technologies

WASHINGTON—The U.S. Department of Energy's Office of Electricity (OE) today announced an approximately $1.9 billion funding opportunity to accelerate urgently needed upgrades to the nation's power grid. These investments will meet rising electricity demand and resource adequacy needs, while lowering electricity costs for American households and businesses. Projects selected through the Speed to Power through Accelerated Reconductoring and other Key Advanced Transmission Technology Upgrades (SPARK) funding opportunity will deliver fast and durable upgrades to the grid with real results.

In line with President Trump's Executive Order, Unleashing American Energy, selected projects will demonstrate how reconductoring—replacing existing power lines with higher-capacity conductors—paired with other Advanced Transmission Technologies (ATTs) can expand grid capacity, increase operational efficiency, lower prices for consumers, and improve overall system reliability and security of the nation's electric grid.

> "For too long, important grid modernization and energy addition efforts were not prioritized by past leaders," said **U.S. Secretary of Energy Chris Wright**. "Thanks to President Trump, we are doing the important work of modernizing our grid so electricity costs will be lowered for American families and businesses."

> "The United States must increase grid capacity to meet demand, and ensure the grid provides reliable power—day-in and day-out," said **OE Assistant Secretary Katie Jereza.** "Through this SPARK funding opportunity, we will stabilize and optimize grid operations to strengthen it for rapid growth."

The SPARK opportunity builds on the Grid Resilience and Innovation Partnerships (GRIP) Program, which provided up to $10.5 billion in competitive funding over five years to states, tribes, electric utilities, and other eligible recipients to strengthen grid resilience and innovation. The previous two GRIP funding rounds covered FY 2022-2023 and FY 2023-2024 funding. Today's announcement continues the mission of the GRIP Program under the SPARK funding opportunity, focusing on the rapid deployment of reconductoring and other ATTs that expand transfer

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capability, strengthen reliability and resource adequacy, and reduce costs for consumers, all while making use of existing rights of way.

Concept papers are due April 1, 2026, and full applications are due May 19, 2026. DOE anticipates making selections in the summer of 2026. An informational webinar will be posted on the OE website by March 18, 2026.

1:39 PM · Mar 12, 2026 · **299.5K** Views

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IanAndyP @IanAndyP · Mar 12
DOE just rolled out a $1.9B SPARK funding program to fast-track reconductoring—swapping higher-capacity conductors on existing lines—plus other advanced transmission upgrades.

It can unlock 50-100% more grid capacity without lengthy new builds or rights-of-way fights, directly
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AlhagiNjie2 @Njie2Alhag7940 · Mar 12
DOE just DROPPED a MASSIVE 💰$1.9 BILLION💰 glow-up for our crumbling gridddd ⚡🔪✨
Upgrading that ancient critical infrastructure + SLASHING your electric billz 📉💸🔥

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King Copper Discovery @KingCopperCorp · Mar 12
Reconductoring and advanced transmission technology increase capacity on existing lines, but the metals that carry that power remain essential. Copper demand continues rising as grids expand to support AI, EVs, and modern energy systems.

1 1 271

David Cranston @DavidYCranston · Mar 12
Lots of opportunity for these innovative technologies to improve our transmission system. Hoping this program pairs well with Order 1920 call for transmission providers to evaluate ATTs as a cost-effective tool for regional transmission planning.

8 1.3K

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